



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 9 ISSUE

Oct 2022

#10

COMING EVENTS

OCTOBER

3rd	Central Coast W'shop
6th	General Meeting
9-23rd	Tassie Run
12th	Committee Meeting
16th	Highfields Garden
28-6th	Charlie's Run

NOVEMBER

3rd	General Meeting
5th	Central Coast W'Shop
9th	Committee Meeting
13th	Sydney Tech W'shop

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Harley Boggis Photo

Fagan Park Picnic Run – 11th September 2022

By Russell Kelly

After days of unpredictable weather Carol and I were nervous about the run and the numbers who would be attending as there had not been any acceptances on the club web site. This was the first run we have organised, and really wanted it to be a success.

A quick ring around to some of the regular run attendees (Allan Whitehouse, Neville Stirton, Rod Richards, and Vince Cessario) convinced me not to worry and that they would contact other members and organise them to come along.

Feeling more confident that there would be some starters we prepared maps of the proposed route to Fagan Park, direction signs, blew up some balloons to mark the entrance and confirmed details with the Park.

I was in contact with the "Friends of Fagan Park" in relation to the parking arrangements as some of the grounds had become waterlogged and could not be used.

They too said not to worry as they had a Plan B. Not sure what it was, but great to know that it had been thought about.

Come the morning of the run and the weather was beautiful, clear skies and nicely warm. Great weather for a hood down run.

As there was some last-minute organisation to be completed at Fagan Park, Carol and I went directly to the park and put out signs and generally got things ready for the starters. I arranged for Neville Stirton to be at the Bull & Bush Hotel parking area at 9.30AM for a 10.00AM start to hand out maps and directions.

Cars coming from the other direction which did not start from the Bull & Bush Hotel started to appear around 10.30. Then there was a flurry of cars arrive, in all 12 Austin-Healeys and two tin tops.

Everyone quickly parked and most then went to the coffee cart at the park for a morning heart starter.

Cont P14



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Another month, another Flat Chat Newsletter, and once more a few words from the Club's president i.e. me. However, this month we have something to celebrate. Helen Vance, when Social Secretary a couple of years ago initiated discussion about forming local area meetings. Your committee didn't take much convincing that we ought to be more proactive in providing opportunities for country members to meet and share the pleasures of owning and travelling in an Austin-Healey. I think everyone is aware of the great success of Colin and Kerrie Rule's monthly Central Coast workshops, but it has taken longer to spread the idea further.

It was Louise and my great pleasure a couple of weeks ago to be invited to the Central West Chapter's inaugural meeting at Bathurst. We braved the forecast rain and took our 100. Despite the odd cloudburst between Lithgow

and our motel we managed to stay relatively dry on the trip to Bathurst. Greg Poole had organised a three-day event starting with an excellent Lebanese style 'banquet' at Maalouf's Restaurant. There we met Greg and Kerri Poole and Marie and Denis Lesslie, current and sometime members of the Club.

Friday morning saw us meet at the National Motor Racing Museum for a trip to Crookwell via Oberon returning by Trunkey Creek.

Cont P16



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 –
gordonl@aussiebb.com.au



COMMITTEE LIST - 2022

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
0403 198 343
gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

Vice-President - Jim Phillips
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jpjimbeau@gmail.com

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0467 563 523
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Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the October 2022 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

With 12 Austin-Healeys (with owners/drivers/passengers) turning up on September 11th it was without doubt a great success. As we all know the 2022 All British Day was cancelled resulting in members looking for an alternative. Thanks to Russell and Carol Kelly, we had one in the form of a simple run and lunch at Fagan Park in the northern suburb of Galston. It had been some time since we had a simple run where members had the chance to exercise their cars, gather with fellow members and then head home with enough time left in the day to mow the lawn, polish the car or trim that hedge. If you have reached these words you would have already read Russell's words on the run and probably the extra words kindly sent in by Harley Boggis.

Also successful were the September Central-Coast

workshop and the Central West Chapter runs organised by Greg Poole. The results of each can be found on pages 10 and 13 respectively.

As with each issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter there are a people to thank. Thanks to Denis Kasza who has written in letting us know how with the help of a few fellow members he has installed an alternator into his Austin Westminster. Also of interest are articles on an interesting auction that took place last month in Texas. For sale at the drop of the hammer were two Austin-Healeys, three Nash-Healeys and a Healey Three Litre Sports Convertible, along with automobilia that sold for quite a pretty penny.

How are your harmonics? I wasn't too sure how mine were until I started to investigate the workings of a harmonic balancer. I may be poorer, but it's good to know that my harmonics are well looked after. See page 24.

Talking about engines, not only is the engine from the Quinn Austin-Healey out of the car, but it's no longer here. With the help of a neighbour and his very useful Dingo Mini Digger the engine was lifted on to the back of the Quinn Hi-Lux. Also leaving our barn was a very early smooth crankcase C-series six-cylinder engine that will probably come in handy. As for the engine, all I am left with, is a shopping list of things to buy.

In the meantime, the original steering wheel is being refurbished with lots and lots of filling and sanding back. Plus the front bumper and overriders are being polished and the dumb irons repainted.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter, and I look forward to receiving your words and photos for the November issue.

Look closely at the AGM material on pages 8 and 9.



Stuff on the back of the Quinn Hi-Lux. Useful thing is a Hi-Lux.

Monthly Meetings

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 1 September 2022.

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

ATTENDEES

32 attendees including two new members

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

Nagy Khoury, visitor. New Members Kathleen and Kristopher Long

APOLOGIES

Julie & Garry Lee, Allan Whitehouse, Mal French, Liz Goodare, Patricia Bancroft, Richard Horwood, Pamela & Doug Ross.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 4 August 2022, as published in the September 2022 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting. Approved by John Sherman, seconded by Terry Bancroft.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Gordon gave a brief update on his recent UK visit including meeting with UK Clubs.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

- Chapters set up on website
- Kerry MacDonald from Canberra has been contacted to set up a Canberra chapter however they have decided to remain separate for the time being.
- Southern highlands group – n/a
- North coast Chapter in Port Macquarie now set up.
- Bathurst group report of a tour and seeks participation from other members.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

No Report.

TREASURER'S REPORT

John advised of the Club's funds at 31 August 2022:

Debit card	\$269.75
Main Account	\$22,872.52
Cash Reserve	\$12,509.26
Charlie's Run	\$3,251.88
Term Deposit	\$79,221.94

Receipts for the month included 2022/23 membership subscriptions (\$1,190), 2023 Rally Deposits (\$5,125) and \$9.30 kindly refunded by Chris Komor for trophy postage.

Payments for the month

Australian Austin-Healey Issue 32 (\$2,035), DMH Birthday cakes (\$59.23) US\$10.70 at Schiphol (to be investigated).

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

- A total of 140 cars attended the recent Make a Wish Foundation display day
- Please register for events that you are going to attend on the website – any issues please contact the Webmaster.
- Technical workshop on 9/11 venue Bankstown?
- Chapters are now setting up their runs.
- Brian Levy expressed his thanks for the number of attendees at the Make a Wish Foundation Display day.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

No report – however any issues trying to register for an event please call Jim Phillips.

MEMBERSHIP

- Six new members for tabling at the next Committee Meeting
- 73 people have registers as interested parties for the 2023 National Rally in the Hunter.
- Christine gave an overview of her recent trip to US attending gatherings and Conclave.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Flat Chat out 31/8, Australian Austin-Healey magazine in the mail.

REGISTRAR

218 cars now on the Club register including 78 marque cars.

HISTORIAN

Joe gave another interesting history concerning the Austin-Healey

**LIBRARIAN**

No Report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/SPARE PARTS

No Report.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Run to Fagan Park scheduled for 11 September.

CMC REPORT

There were 1900 cars at the CMC Sydney Motorsport Park.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

Next meeting maybe October.

CSCA REPORT

- MG Sydney at Pheasant Wood cancelled.
- Jaguar Supersprint at Sydney Motorsport Park next event.
- Wakefield Park Goulburn is now "closed" until further notice currently under review after response from Land & Environment

Court – watch this space for further developments.

- Patrick Townshend competing in Baskerville Tas along with Chris Komor who is running his 100.

REGALIA

- Club offerings available to purchase.
- Colin presented back to the Club the two volumes of "Gullwing to Spyder the last Healeys at Le Mans" now signed by Robert Harrison with his story included.

FOR SALE/WANTED

Nil.

GENERAL BUSINESS

- Greg Poole Bathurst letter regarding Bathurst Chapter setup and the planned run.
- Patrick Quinn extended his thanks to Ray Roberts for help with SU pumps.

Meeting concluded at 8:59pm.

We have received the below email in support of the future of Wakefield Park - Please Consider

Dear NSW Car Club,

We are trying to save a permanent motorsport facility in the town of Goulburn NSW 2580.

We just wanted to reach out and see if your car club is willing to support the E-petition that we will be launching shortly through NSW Parliament.

The E-petition will be created through NSW Parliament and we will have a 3-week window to get at least 20,000 signatures from NSW Residents. If we hit the 20,000 number the Petition and issue regarding Wakefield Park's future will be tabled in parliament and debated.

Will you help share the E-Petition link through your member's list and socials to help us get at least 20,000 signatures and show support for Saving Wakefield Park?

We currently have a website [Save Wakefield Park](http://SaveWakefieldPark.com) set up where anyone can register to get all the updates and the E-Petition link to add your signature once it's LIVE via email next week.

Your support would be greatly appreciated.

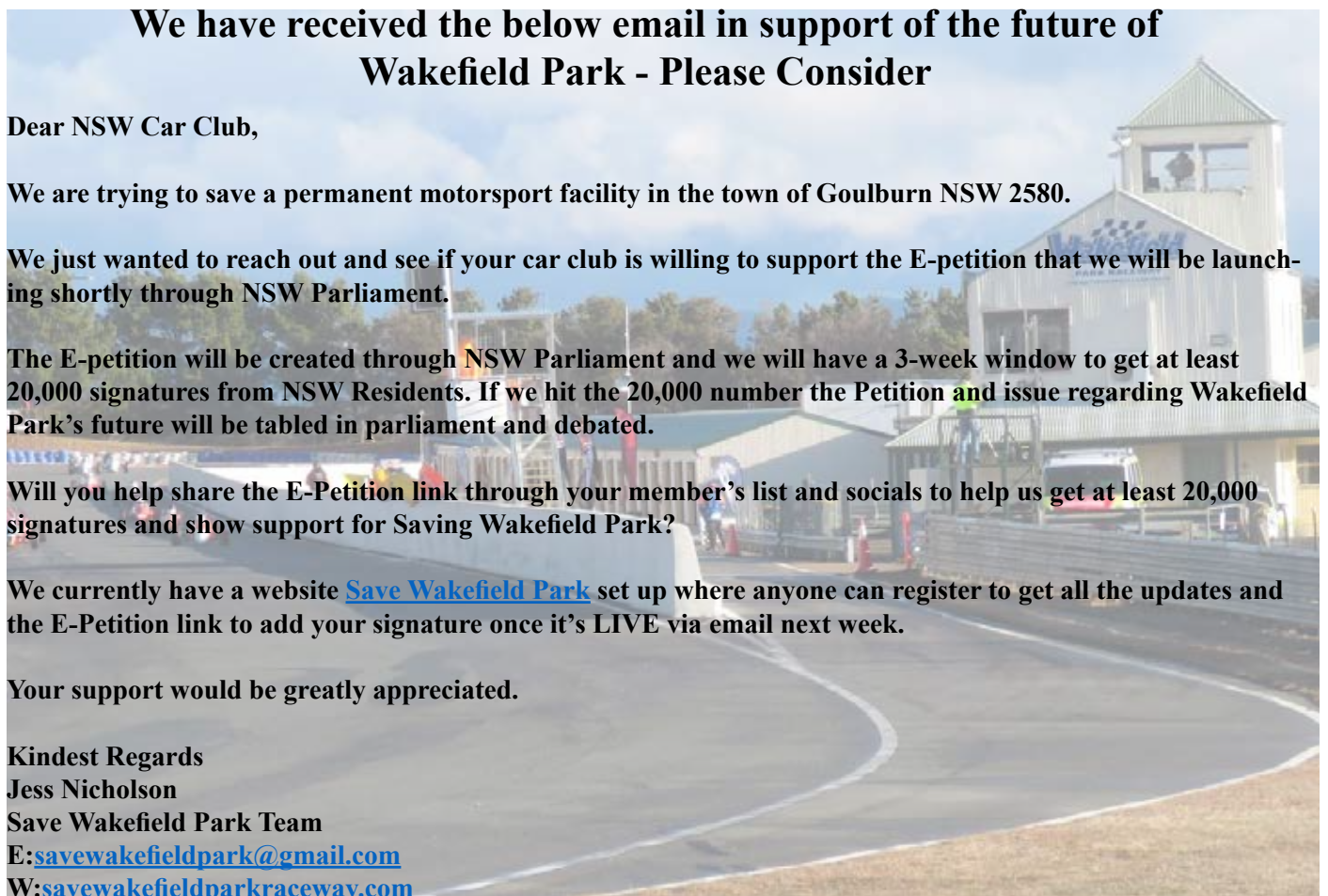
Kindest Regards

Jess Nicholson

Save Wakefield Park Team

E:savewakefieldpark@gmail.com

W:savewakefieldparkraceway.com





Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493

bruceewan1@gmail.com

COMING UP

Event: **Sydney Technical Workshop**

Date: Saturday 9 October

Times: 9:00am – 12:00pm

CANCELLED

Event: **Highfields Garden**

Date: Sunday 16 October

Times: 10:00am – 4:00pm

Address: 111 John Grant Road, Little Hartley

Entry: \$15

Highfield Gardens has been featured on TV, newspapers and in many books. Some examples include *Better Homes and Gardens*, the front cover image and extensive inside feature in the book by Claire Takacs 'Australian Dreamscapes' as well as other publications and media.

This large garden is still being extended to include formal gardens and a potager.

There are many garden rooms within the gardens including the Dry Garden, Prairie Garden, Birch

Membership Report

Christine Lyttle 0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

New members this month are:

- Thomas Birouste and Anne Bunde-Birouste from Clareville with a 1963 3000 MKII BJ7 previously owned by Peter and Candice Anderson
- Henry Westmacott from Woollahra as an Associate Member.

Welcome Thomas, Anne and Henry to the Club and look forward to seeing you at an event or meeting soon.

It's been a very busy month. I am the Rally Registrar for our National Rally to be held at the Hunter Valley's Chateau Elan from 2-5 May 2023 and we have 130 registered.

Grove, Rock Garden/Water Garden with two waterfalls, The long border (AKA Barry Manilow border) and single-coloured borders. This is an all season garden filled with many unusual plants and trees. Highfields Garden profiles a new trend of no water gardens where plants are watered till established and beyond that, survive on rain only.

Meeting point for those coming from Sydney is the Hawkesbury Visitor Information Centre, Hawkesbury Valley Way, Clarendon opposite the Richmond RAAF base at 9am for a 9:15 departure along Bells Line of Road to Bell and then along to Darling Causeway to Mt Victoria and on to Little Hartley.

Event: **Sydney Technical Workshop**

Date: Saturday 13 November

Times: 9:00am – 12:00pm

Address: TBA

Register: PLEASE register in advance so that we can cater accordingly

Bring: Morning tea to share e.g. cake, biscuits or similar.

Event: **AHOC Christmas Party (and AGM)**

Date: Thursday 1 December

Time: 7.00pm

Address: Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135

MORE DETAILS TO FOLLOW

Should you be interested in attending the National Rally – see documents in this Flat Chat or contact me on rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com and I will forward the necessary documents to complete. Our numbers are limited so do not delay, book today!!

Please note that at any time if you wish to resign your membership – it would be appreciated if you could let me know in writing (email) as this information is required in writing as per the Club Constitution.

Look forward to seeing you at the general meeting this Thursday.

Keep safe and well!

Happy Healey



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Depending on who serves you at your local Services NSW office you could out the door in a few minutes or have to make multiple visits.

Recently a new member lined up to place his Austin-Healey on Conditional Registration and having all the necessary paperwork thought it would be straight forward. However, it was not to be, as his Pink Slip stating that his car was roadworthy didn't fully identify his car. In other words, the person who did the inspection didn't write the identifying numbers on the form or the chassis/engine number. So it was back to the inspection station with the papers to

be freshly signed and a second trip to his Services NSW office. It was then successfully finalised.

While this was for a car new to Conditional Registration, I suggest to everyone that if you submit a Pink Slip either when starting out or renewing, make sure that the person completing the form identifies the car on the form.

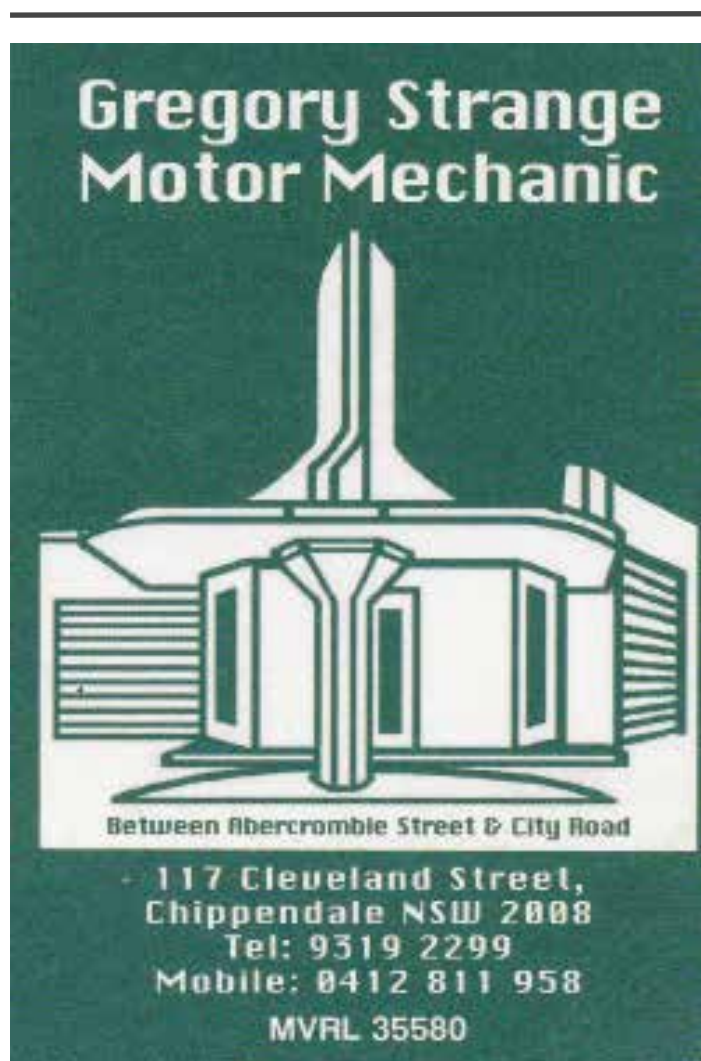
It's still happening! Over the last month I have been asked by club members how to renew their Conditional Registration. It makes me wonder if they read the *Flat Chat Newsletter* where the steps required have been laid out monthly over the last few years.

- Once you have received the renewal from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.

- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.

- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

PLEASE DON'T FORGET THE STAMPED SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE.

A green rectangular advertisement for Gregory Strange Motor Mechanic. At the top, the name "Gregory Strange Motor Mechanic" is written in a bold, white, sans-serif font. Below the text is a white line drawing of a classic open-top car, viewed from a front-three-quarter angle. Underneath the car, the text "Between Abercrombie Street & City Road" is written in a smaller white font. At the bottom of the advertisement, the following contact information is listed in white: "117 Cleveland Street, Chippendale NSW 2008", "Tel: 9319 2299", "Mobile: 0412 811 958", and "MVRL 35580".



Annual General Meeting

Probably is the most exciting meeting that we have during the year, and usually held in conjunction with the November meeting. This meeting is to elect the members of the committee, receive the financial report for the year ended 30 June 2022 and any other business that may arise from prior AGM's.

Many would be aware that normally most of the time is taken up with the election of committee members.

This year, because there are a few members away in November it has been suggested to hold it at the Christmas Party scheduled for 1st December.

If we can follow the procedures set out in the constitution it will ensure that the AGM runs very smoothly and takes the minimum amount of time to get through the legal requirements and more time for partying.

The procedures:-

- A notice outlining the object of the meeting will be issued prior and requesting that nominations for the various committee positions be lodged within the required time frame.
- Only those lodged notifications where there are two or more names provided will be voted on. If there is only one nomination received by the cut off time that person becomes the committee member.
- If there are no nominations then the position is decided at the meeting nominating, seconding and acceptance by the nominee.

Therefore, the more positions that have prior nominations, the less time needs to be spent on that part of the AGM.

Committee positions

A list of all positions and current officers are set out on page two of Flat Chat. As at the last committee meeting most of the current committee have expressed their interest in staying on the committee, but if you or a member you know, would be prepared to join then talk to the current member and find out what's involved.

The Unknowns

President - Gordon Lynas (also president of the national association and the chair of the 2023 rally committee) will be spending more time in 2023 travelling now that Covid restrictions are easing and with his family living overseas will continue if no one else will nominate.

Treasurer - John Sherman has indicated that he will continue to support Gordon, but will leave with a change of presidents.

Regalia - Colin Rule has also indicated that after all the years that he would be stepping down.

Webmaster - Will happily give up the position to anyone that would like to take on the role.

So, to ensure that the AGM runs smoothly the more positions for which we have prior nominations the better it will be. To do this:-

1. See the next page for the nomination form;
2. Approach a member about accepting nomination for a position and find a seconder or better still nominate yourself and find a couple of members that will complete the form; and
3. Forward the completed form to the secretary by the date and time specified in the notice of the AGM that will be issued.

Jim Phillips
Vice President

[illegible]

Central Coast September Workshop



The Austin-Healey liveried VW van of Tony Ash next to the BJ8 of Julie Lee and Jim Phillips' 100/6

“Rain, hail or shine!” The Central Coast September 3rd Saturday morning Workshop went ahead on the third and yes it did rain. Actually, it bucketed down, but no hail and no sunshine!! However, 16 brave Austin-Healey enthusiasts arrived. Two Austin-Healey and the rest were in tin tops. Tony Ash turned up in his Austin-Healey muraled VW van all the way from Diamond Beach some 240Ks to the north.

The main attraction for the workshop morning was Graham Healey, and may I say a BIG thank you to Graham for coming from the South Coast to give us a wonderful and fascinating story of his grandfather Donald Healey and the Healey family. Well done Graham!!

Oh yes!! Graham's Talk was videoed thanks to the expertise of Scott Parry-Jones and his trusty camera.



Garry Lee and Harley Boggis enjoying their coffee.



In the Rule workshop out of the rain.



There is a third Austin-Healey parked out of the weather.

Workshop Cont'

A hearty welcome also to Chris Dimmock, Tony Ash, Russ and Margaret Olson and John Walton all first timers to the workshop mornings.

Coffee, cookies and cake were on-tap all morning, the library was up and running as well as a model car display. Geoff Smith was busy carrying out rego checks, which is one of the big benefits of the Saturday morning workshops. Thank you Geoff.

To finish off the morning we had a barbecue lunch ending around 1.30pm. A very successful workshop morning indeed.

Attendees were, Scott Parry-Jones, Roger Ramsay,

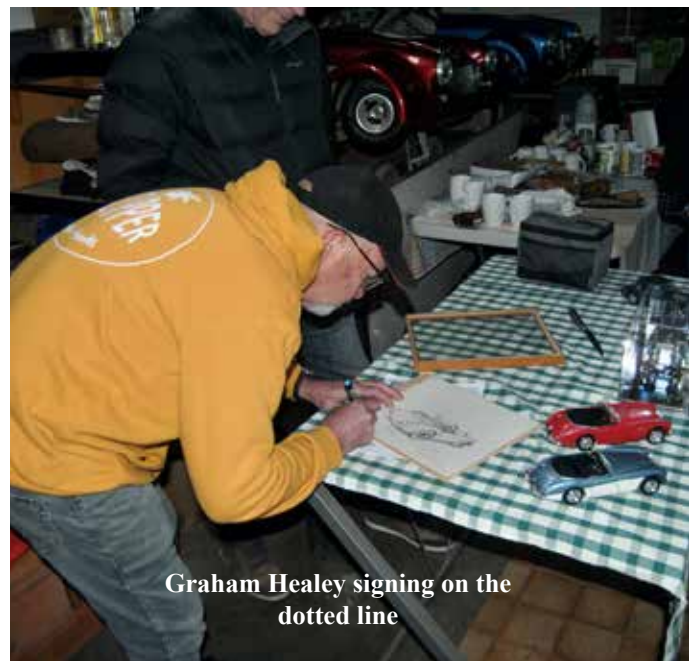
John Walton, Chris Jenkins, Chris Dimmock, Graham Healey, Harley Boggis, Tony Ash, Doug Ross, Julie and Garry Lee BJ8, Louise Hicken, Jim Phillips 100/6, Geoff Smith, John Wakeling, Russ and Margaret Olson, Col and Kerrie Rule BN2.

The October Workshop will be held at Geoff Smith's home at 20 Long Arm Parade, St Huberts Island, starting at 9 am. Don't forget to bring cake and cookies.

Happy Healeying and all the best for now.
Col and Kerrie Rule.



It's stopped raining.



Graham Healey signing on the dotted line



Chris Dimmock and Graham Healey



Russ and Margaret Olson with Kerrie Rule.





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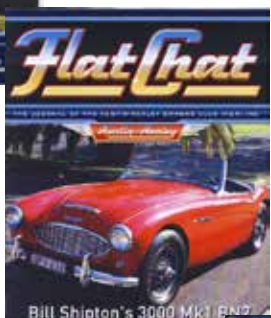
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Flat Chat Back Issues

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Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005
through to October 2022.

That's 180+ issues for you to read at your leisure.
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send
a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



CENTRAL – WEST CHAPTER RUN

Words and pics by Greg Poole

Thursday September 15th, the eve of our planned adventures, was menacing with substantial rain east of the ranges but, characteristically, nowhere nearly as wet in Bathurst as we met at Maalouf's Restaurant for a typically generous dinner with our hardy Sydney brethren who had endured the journey that afternoon.

However, and as requested, Friday and Saturday were typically ideal for touring. Our Friday run began in continuous good weather as we met at the National Motor Racing Museum with a turn around the circuit to begin the journey. Our route to Crookwell for lunch took us by Oberon, Black Springs and Taralga on mostly excellent roads, despite recent heavy rains in the days before. Following lunch and a refuel for the Austin-Healeys we then headed for home by Trunkey Creek and Perthville for a total daily mileage of 328 kilometres.

Dinner Friday night was a sell-out with fully ten of us enjoying a most agreeable meal at the Rose Garden Restaurant, the occasional libation and tales of travels, adventures and, of course Austin-Healeys. The gravitas personae at the dinner table consisted of Gordon and Louise Lynas (AH 100), Colin and son Geoff Goldsmith (Lexus rocket), Marie and Denis Lesslie (Mazda 'F1'), Greg Tucker and Sandy Matiszik (BJ8) and Kerri and I (BJ8). Mealtime conversation meandered for so long that we missed our after-dinner ice-creams at Annie's Ice Cream Parlour just next door.

Saturday again dawned gloriously for our run to Millthorpe by the Mitchell Hwy and Victoria Road on occasional sections of degraded surface. Following a brief tour of this picturesque colonial era town, all enjoyed an early lunch and still more conviviality. Familiarly, numerous passers-by could not help but stop to share their youth-time tales of sports car experiences (there must have been a frightful number of MGs back then ...). Our visitors then headed back to Sydney as a couple of us patronised the lolly shop (with exquisite delights including giant-sized 'freckles') before departing for Bathurst via Blayney on good roads. Total mileage Bathurst-Millthorpe-Bathurst was 89 kilometres.

Unsurprisingly, there were no mechanical or other issues with any of the Austin-Healeys nor with the other chariots.

We are most grateful for the support of Gordon and other Club persons; including other members who offered their apologies for inability to come over the mountains to join us.

We are not planning another substantial run until, say, January or February 2023, preparatory to the National Rally; however, we will have another modest run before then which will be advertised in Flat Chat and, of course, all members will be most welcome to join us for a day or more.



Fagan Park Cont'

Allan Whitehouse Photos this page.

We then visited the various exhibitions which had been opened for our benefit. The 1914 International truck was an incredible restoration. Solid rubber tyres and many hand made parts. The side trays of the truck were silky oak timber. To give you some idea of the authenticity of the project the timber for the side trays of the truck came from trees grown on Friends of Fagan Park members' homes who cut the trees, seasoned the timber, sawed the timbers to size and then arranged to dress the timber at Dural Men's Shed. What an effort!

There were also many other ancient mechanical devices available for inspection. The inspection of the original home "Neatherby" was incredible. It was like stepping back into the last century.

For those who could not make the run I fully recommend a visit to Fagan Park.

After the inspections were completed, we had our picnic lunches and sat around and socialised. Elizabeth Goodare produced some home-made slices



Cont' next page.

The October monthly meeting is scheduled for Thursday the 6th at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm

Fagan Park cont'

which were shared around to the delight of all.

As the day was coming to an end I thanked the Friends of Fagan Park for their efforts, and they have since emailed me saying what a pleasure it was to have us at the park and invited us to return for another

picnic day in the future.

Carol and I were at last relaxed and feel that the day was a great success. A quick tidy up and we departed for home while there was still day light.

Club Run to Fagan Park.

By Harley Boggis

On Sunday 11th September we enjoyed a perfect spring day and a short, but pleasant run to Fagan Park at Galston.

Most met at the Bull and Bush at Baulkham Hills around 9:30am for a 10am start. One 100 arrived trailing an ominous looking line of oil - a loose oil filter was soon tightened; one BJ8 had minor surgery to the right hand tail light to 'fix' the blinker; and another BJ8 almost disappeared into one of the car park's massive potholes. Happily, all proceed without further incident!

Russell and Carol Kelly organised the event and got to Fagan Park early to organise balloons and AHOC signs on the gate, directing us to private parking near the homestead. All up there was a good turnout with 12 Austin-Healeys (plus sedans).

Having parked, first on the agenda was to walk over for a coffee and a bit of a look around the grounds. Fagan Park is known for its gardens, but there is much more to see - the historic homestead, sheds with farm equipment and gems from yesteryear. Well worth a visit!

There were a lot of smiling AHOC members and I think a pleasant day was had by all. Attendees included Russell and Carol Kelly BJ8, Ross Penman BJ8, George and Liz Goodare 100M, Vince and Natalie Cessario BJ8, Ray and Muriel Roberts BJ8, Neville Stirton and Rod Richards BJ7, Darryl and Cheryl Dobe 100, Richard Lloyd 100, Allan Whitehouse BJ7, Damian and Sheena Carrick BJ8, Harley Boggis BJ8, Andrew and Debra James 100/6, Dennis Kasza and Susie Austin Westminster, Larry and Helen Johns with granddaughter..



Photos by Harley Boggis



Pres Message Cont'

Local member Greg Tucker and Sandy joined Greg and Kerri for this nice arrangement of one of the original models of Austin-Healey sandwiched between two of the final variants.



Greg Poole and Louise Lynas rugged up whilst Greg Tucker and Sandy are ready for the 'off'.

Denis and Marie Lesslie joined us in their tin-top and Colin Goldsmith and son Geoff rounded out the party in Colins' lovely Lexus. Being on the circuit, we just had to line up the Austin-Healeys on the grid.

Saturday saw us lunching at Millthorpe, a much shorter drive than Friday's, but still most enjoyable. Elsewhere in this Flat Chat you can read Greg's more detailed report of the weekend. The Sydney contingent very much enjoyed the trip and local hospitality and thank Greg and Kerri for organising



Greg Poole has aligned the cars while Louise Lynas heads for safety.

it all for us. Louise and I look forward to visiting Bathurst again soon and encourage everyone to get along to support our local chapters. To that end, there are rumblings of forming Chapters on the Mid-North Coast and also in the Southern Highlands. I wish them well and look forward to joining them for one or two of their meetings in the very near future. Apart from local chapters, the 2023 National Rally registration is now open. We have 100 rooms reserved at Chateau Elan and already we have pre-registrations for 2/3rd of them. So, book your place! This is going to be MEMORABLE! You really won't want to miss out.

Happy Healeying

Gordon



Sandy and Greg Tucker, Greg Poole, Colin Goldsmith, Geoff Goldsmith, Marie and Denis Lesslie and Kerri Poole enjoy dinner together.

PURPLE HAZE – CHARLIE’S RUN 2022

In 2018 Charlie’s regulars will recall that we went north and had a lovely time meeting fellow Queensland and Northern NSW members at Inverell and Dorrigo. Over a glass or two of wine one evening on that trip, it was suggested that it would be great if one year Charlie’s Run was to visit the Grafton Jacaranda Festival. This is an event that a select group of northern members have made a fixture in their calendar for a number of years. As they recommended it so highly, this year you have the opportunity to join them to enjoy the oldest floral festival in Australia.

This year, the Festival is being held from 28 October to 6 November, although we will be visiting for only a few of those days. As usual we will take a relaxed tour both to get there and to return. Our provisional schedule is as follows:

Wednesday, 2 November –
travel to Gloucester.

Thursday, 3 November –
Gloucester to Armidale via Thunderbolt’s Way.

Friday, 4 November –
arrive at Grafton and meet with the northerners.

Saturday and Sunday, 5 & 6 November –
at Grafton to enjoy the festivities.

Monday, 7 November –
depart Grafton for Port Macquarie.

Tuesday, 8 November –
overnight at Tea Gardens

Wednesday, 9 November –
Home.

This should mean that we will driving for around three hours each day leaving time for a leisurely lunch and to have a stroll around town each afternoon.

The cost of this run will be around \$550 per room for seven nights’ accommodation. As we have limited numbers this year, we can take advantage of some

smaller towns and motels, however these generally don’t have restaurants attached. Hence meals will be for you to decide at each location, although I suspect that our northern contingent will at least be able to provide good advice of where to eat. I suspect that we will probably organise a BBQ or such like for at least one of our Grafton evenings.

The Festival is very popular and accommodation is limited so don’t delay in booking your place. To do so, email or call Gordon (gordonl@aussiebb.com.au, or 0403 198 343) and don’t forget to pay your deposit of \$50 per person to the club by electronic funds transfer, including your name and reference ‘Jacaranda’.

If you can’t add a text reference, most banks will allow you to add a numeric reference so please use your club membership number or, if you don’t know that, your Postcode, to help me identify your payment.

If you are not able to make an electronic funds transfer, please deposit a cheque at your local Westpac bank payable to the Austin-Healey Owners Club NSW account detailed below and let Gordon know that you have done so by email or phone.

Westpac Bank: BSB 032 669, A/c no. 277411
‘AHOC Charlies Run’

Happy travels

Gordon Lynas





Unforgettable memories...



**Tuesday 2 May –
Friday 5 May 2023**



Chateau Elan

in the heart of the
famed Hunter Valley

Vintage Drive, Pokolbin NSW 2320

Nestled among rolling vineyards and
overlooking manicured fairways, breathtaking
scenery for its comprehensive offering, the
resort offers luxury hotel style accommodation

A Luxurious Holiday Experience in the Hunter Valley

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Bookings direct to the Resort in advance



**Bookings for the Resort must be made on the Chateau Elan's booking form
and sent with the payment direct to the Resort**

Note Resort costs are not included in the ticket price of \$500



THE AUSTIN-HEALEY 2023 NATIONAL RALLY
TUESDAY 2 MAY – FRIDAY 5 MAY 2023

REGISTRATION FORM

**REGISTRATIONS CLOSE ON
TUESDAY 31 JANUARY 2023**

unless numbers are at capacity and then you will be shortlisted

Rally Registrar:

Christine Lyttle

Email: rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com

Mail: PO Box 2754,

North Parramatta NSW 1750

Mobile: 0410 201 373

ADULTS ATTENDING

1.	2.
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Regrettably no children to attend this event

YOUR PERSONAL DETAILS

Postal Address:

Suburb:	State:	Postcode:
---------	--------	-----------

Club:	Mobile:
-------	---------

Email:

Special Dietary Requirements (please tick box in front or make comment):

☐ Diabetes ☐ Coeliac ☐ Gluten Free ☐ Vegetarian Other _____

CAR DETAILS

REGISTRATION NUMBER

☐ 100	☐ 100S	☐ 100/6	☐ 3000 MKI
☐ 3000 MKII	☐ 3000 MKIII	☐ SPRITE	☐ MODIFIED

OTHER



THE AUSTIN-HEALEY 2023 NATIONAL RALLY
TUESDAY 2 MAY – FRIDAY 5 MAY 2023

REGISTRATION FORM

Page 2

National Rally Ticket Price Includes:

- ❖ Welcome party including food and drinks
- ❖ Party Night including dinner and drinks
- ❖ Gala Dinner including dinner, drinks and entertainment
- ❖ Car display show and shine event
- ❖ And more....

Please complete below		\$440		
Number of Adults		@ \$500	Total	\$
Booking of Interest completed	Date:		Amount Paid	\$
			Sub Total	\$
Ticket Price is in Australian Dollars			Total Due	\$

The Ticket Price has been reduced by \$60 to cover the breakfast @ \$20 per person per day due to the Resort accommodation system

The registration form is also available on our website: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

PAYMENT OF RALLY TICKETS – receipt will be issued for all monies received	
DIRECT DEPOSIT - EFT	Account Name: Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Incorporated Westpac Banking Corporation BSB: 032 669 Account Number: 252564 Date amount deposited: ____ / ____ / ____ Please enter your SURNAME RALLY 2023 in reference field to reconcile
CHEQUE / MONEY ORDER	Made payable to Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Incorporated Mail to address on Page 1 to the Registrar
Registrations will not be finalised until full payment is received	

Rally ticket refunds available until 30 days prior to the start of the event.
 Full cancellation fee applies after this due to commitments to the Resort and other venues, the organising committee cannot guarantee a refund.
 A reminder – if cancelling do not forget to contact the Resort to cancel your room and check their refund rules

REGISTRAR USE DATE RECEIVED ____ / ____ / ____ RECEIPT SENT ____ / ____ / ____ REGISTRATION NO ____

Comments _____

Austin-Healeys make their presence felt at Tasmanian Baskerville Historics

Thanks to Becher Townshend

As foreshadowed a couple of months back, AHOC member Patrick Townshend and his brother Becher returned to the Tasmania's Baskerville Historic race meeting along with fellow members Chris Komor.

Patrick and Becher had entered their six-cylinder cars and Chris his much raced 100. Unfortunately Patrick's car (ex-Colin Goldsmith) didn't make the meeting due to mechanical issues. (see So Becher's car (ex-Brian Duffy) was also entered in Regularity.

Becher joined Chris racing in Group S and Invited Marque Sports Cars, putting the Komor 100 against the 100/6 – with Becher taking a win in Group Sa and Chris second place.

This was the first run in the former Duffy 100/6 in the hands of new owner Becher and the vehicle didn't disappoint, setting a new lap record for Sa at Baskerville of 1.04.97.

Chris has promised to return, describing the Baskerville Historics as one of the most enjoyable events on calendar.

Both Chris and Becher also enjoyed running in the Lufra Hillclimb the month before, located on the historic Tasman Peninsula, with both drivers vowing to return as well next year.



Chris Komor (100) and Becher Townshend (100) readying for the Lufra Hillclimb.



The 3000 is Phillip Tompson at the Lufra Hillclimb. GSV Media Photo.



Patrick Townshend three-wheeling his brother's Austin-Healey at Baskerville.

Charging Ahead by Denis Kasza



A while back the ignition light was glowing red-hot in my Austin A99 Westminister while mobile. I was advised by an auto electrician to put in a new voltage regulator as a first step to rectifying the charging system. A new Indian knock-off unit was installed, but this worked for a short time only, so the next step was to look at the generator. The upshot there was that the generator needed new brushes and insulation tape. However, the problem returned and being unable to get a genuine new old stock Lucas generator and a similar voltage regulator, I decided to install an alternator on the advice of Ray Roberts and our Technical Officer Greg Strange.



As to history and originality, many would know, by remembering to back in the day, and by these days watching period TV shows and movies, the BMC Westminsters and Wolseleys were quite commonly used as police cars in the '60s. They were popular as

traffic pursuit vehicles and area cars with UK police, due to their size, three-litre power, and relative cheapness. Westminsters were also used by the South African police service and possibly, but not to my knowledge, by police forces in other Commonwealth countries.



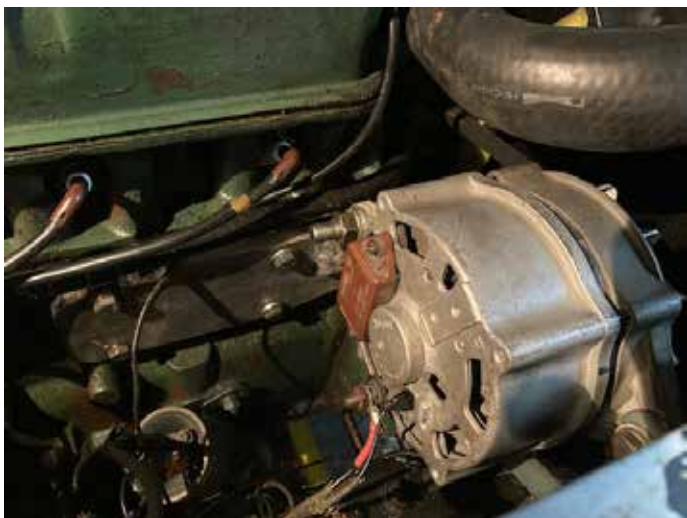
The cars were tweaked to Austin-Healey specification for pursuit by some UK forces, but they usually ran alternators instead of generators and had larger batteries, to cope with the extra demands of the radio equipment.

An ex-UK policeman said that the Westminsters and Wolseleys were the finest area cars they'd had in his time. Also, a retired traffic patrol officer said that in

Cont' next page

Charging Ahead cont'

his experience, the Jaguars did not cut it as police cars, being not a patch on the Austins for reliability and toughness.



Regarding my car again, in addition to the alternator, which has now been installed, I might one day grace it with a higher profile camshaft, flat-top pistons, an Austin-Healey cylinder head with intake manifold, bigger SU carbs, or Webers, extractors, a twin exhaust system and upgraded crankshaft bearings. Might! However not so sure about the police badging, siren, and radio equipment. Actually, I have been well advised to carry on enjoying the car as it is...



Back to the charging system - I'm grateful to Neville Stirton, who obtained and installed the alternator, with its Denis Welch style Austin-Healey machined bracket, to Ray Roberts for his advice and electrical expertise and to Rod Richards for his help.

I'm now confident that the upcoming Highfields Gardens excursion and our proposed partial involvement in Charlie's Run will not be subject to breakdowns relating to the charging system.

Fingers crossed for the rest of the car.


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Balancing my Harmonics

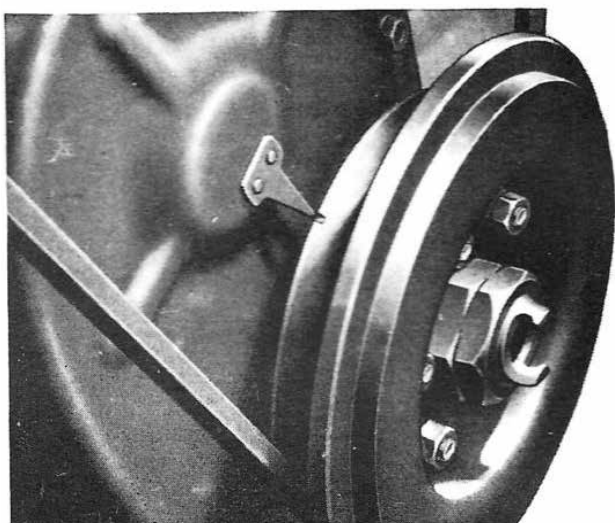
By Patrick Quinn

Do I need my harmonics balanced? How do I balance them? What is a harmonic?

With the engine out of the Quinn Austin-Healey (tragic story, so don't ask) the original crankshaft pulley was looked at closely. While it was all in one piece, it did look as if it's seen better days. (It's away so no photo) I looked in the mirror and wondered the same thing.

So over a cup of tea, Neville Stirton and I considered the longevity of the original 68 year old crankshaft pulley and pondered that when the engine is going back together, should we use it or get something better?

"You should fit a harmonic balancer." Came Neville's suggestion between sips of tea.



Straight out of the manual.

I needed to know more about this often mentioned piece of kit, that I must admit that I knew little about. So with the help of Dr Google I made up this layperson's explanation.

Well, we all know that the crankshaft in our Austin-Healeys are made from solid pieces of iron and when the engine is running they spin at pretty high speeds. For instance if you touring at 2,500 rpm in top overdrive, that piece of iron is spinning around 42 times every single second. Mind boggling really to think about that long piece of metal spinning around and that's for a fairly ancient engine, so imagine what it must be like for modern engines that rev a lot faster.

So when the crankshaft spins around it would be nice to think that it does so in a perfectly cyclic action. Well it doesn't, as it vibrates and twists. You can't see it of course, but while driving you can certainly feel the difference between a well-balanced engine and one that is not. I have heard it said a number of times, that the standard 100 four-cylinder engine with its long stroke, the crankshaft will eventually break. Sounds ominous doesn't it?

When the C-Series six-cylinder engine was first introduced in 1954 the designers stuck something the size of a really thick bread and butter plate on the crankshaft at the front of the engine, and connected behind that is the fanbelt pulley.

The purpose of the bread and butter plate is to smooth out the inherent vibration of the metal spinning round and round, which it did very well when the engine wasn't that far past its foundry birth. That's for the six-cylinder cars, as the four-cylinder engines weren't fitted with one at all, so the poor crankshaft had to deal with its vibrations all by itself.

Torsional vibration is an interesting thing that I am sure a few years of an engineering degree would help you to understand. However imagine you were at the end of the crankshaft under number six piston. Bang! The combustion happens direct above you and down comes the piston and rod. Now think about whether the end of the crankshaft at number six feels the energy at the same time as the other end of the crankshaft. The answer is no! The difference is infinitesimal, but it does exist. However in everyday driving does it really matter? Probably not. Of course it all happens in reverse when number one fires and when any of the others fire. So it's happening all along the crankshaft, and to put to pain to injury it all doesn't turn at exactly the same time. Got a headache yet?

Having said that I don't want to ever pull the engine out of the Quinn Austin-Healey ever again in my lifetime, so I don't wish to take chances.

Question after question – all answered, except one. How much is it?

Cont' next page

Balance cont'

Well like most things in life it pays to shop around. I'm pleased to say that Pro-Race harmonic balancers are made in Australia and by the time it arrived at my gate it cost \$508.

Looking at it, I would call it pretty in an industrial sense!!! Plus, it has the big bonus being designed to

fit both the four and six-cylinder Big Healey engines.

It's made from two pieces of machined steel vulcanised together and fits over the end of the crankshaft and there is a slot for the woodruff key.

Now the decision to paint it or not.

It's March 2019 and the then Prince of Wales and the Duchess of Cornwall are in Cuba for the first official visit.

Yes it is a Healey Silverstone (One of 106 built).

This car (D10) sat in the same garden as a Mercedes Gullwing for years until it was rescued and restored by a Spanish gentleman in the hope that he can get it out of the country. It's still there..



An Interesting Auction

by Patrick Quinn



The Gene Ponder Collection - Thank you to RM Sotheby's for the photos.

Frankly the name of Gene Ponder meant nothing to me until an email came in for US auction house RM Sotheby's. Mr Ponder had decided that his collection of 120 European sports cars plus automobilia was to be placed on auction along with a swag of automobilia.

It appears that Mr Ponder, who is in the kitchen business, had gathered together over a period of 15 years, an incredible number of rare original classics and recreations.

The auction was held over 22-24 September in Marshall, Texas and included in the sale are the normal cars of interest to fellow collectors including Ferrari, Bugattis, MG and Mercedes-Benz. Interestingly this wasn't Mr Ponder's first such auction as he had one

in 2007 when following a heart attack he sold 60 similar cars, but as soon as he recovered he started collecting again.

Over the years there are plenty of like auctions, but this one was a little interesting in that it included three Nash-Healeys, a Healey Three-Litre Sports Convertible (aka Alvis-Healey), a Bug Eye Sprite and a 3000 Mk1. On top of that were a number of Austin-Healey orientated illuminated signs that sold for generous figures.

Next to the photos I will include the hammer price in US\$ followed by the Au\$ based on current exchange rates. While the prices of the cars were of interest, the signs really impressed.

Austin-Healey 3000 Mk1 BT7 sold for US\$77,000 or Au\$119,000.

A good looking car that has since been the subject of discussion on Facebook.

It was purchased as a birthday present by a gentleman for his wife. On Facebook he also sought advice on maintenance and amount of use.



Auction cont'



1953 Healey Three-Litre Sports Convertible (aka Alvis Healey)

A total of 28 built with the Alvis three-litre engine and gearbox.

This car sold for US\$104,500 or Au\$161,500.

1951 Nash-Healey Roadster.

The initial Nash-Healeys were fitted with alloy bodies made by Panelcraft that also later made the bodies for the Three-Litre Sports Convertible. 104 were built.

Sold for US\$154,000 or Au\$238,000.



1952 Nash-Healey Roadster.

By 1952, body production had moved off-shore to Pinin Farina in Italy. Bodies were constructed in steel and were available in roadster and coupe styles.

Sold for US\$82,500 or Au\$127,500.

1953 Nash-Healey Roadster.

Also bodied in steel by Pinin Farina. In total 250 Roadsters and 150 Coupes were built.

This car sold for US\$93,500 or Au\$144,500.



Auction cont'



Austin-Healey Sprite Mk1.

Prepared for Historic Motorsport. Fitted with Judson supercharger.

Sold for US\$34,100 or Au\$53,000.



Sold for US\$5,175 or Au\$8,000.



Sold for US\$6,325 or Au\$9,800.



Sold for US\$9,775 or Au\$15,100.



Sold for US\$13,800 or Au\$21,400.

When you see the price that this gem went for, you can only imagine that there were probably a number of spirited bidders.

It sold for US\$21,850 or Au\$33,800.



FOR SALE & WANTED**1955 Austin-Healey 100 BN1**

This car has been in the same ownership for over 25 years and is in very nice condition.

It has travelled on many Charlie's Runs as well as other Austin-Healey Owners Club runs.

It has had only minor modifications such as heat

FOR SALE & WANTED

shields for the fuel system and spin on/off oil filter. Also recently had radiator out and flushed and a new thermostat fitted.

The car is painted Old English White with some panels recently refinished. Red leather upholstery and red carpet. Currently road registered. \$78,000

Please call Harold Johnston on 0411 519 959.



Wanted three litre motor complete or incomplete.

Three litre cylinder head

Sump to suit a three litre motor

Please call

Patrick Townshend

0407 075 997

FOR SALE & WANTED

Austin-Healey 3000 MK3 BJ8

For sale is my 1964 Austin-Healey 3000 Mk3 BJ8. When it arrived into my care it was riddled with rust, but otherwise straight and complete. It has since been completely restored with most components having been replaced including high torque starter motor, spin off oil filter, electronic ignition, fuel pump, radiator, water pump, harmonic balancer and Australian brake booster. The engine has been completely rebuilt and includes larger valves, a slightly warmer camshaft and new seals front and rear.

The SUs have been rebuilt and run well. New tele-

FOR SALE & WANTED

scopic shock absorbers have been fitted to the front suspension and a reconditioned steering box is fitted. Finished in metallic dark blue with red interior.

Comes with manuals and receipt file. The car is in good condition and is a reliable road car and has completed trips to several national events plus trips to Tasmania and Cairns from the Northern Rivers region of New South Wales where it is garaged.

Price: \$110,000

Please contact Don Philbrook: 0401 834 954
donphilbrook2@gmail.com



It's Cherry Blossom time in Japan and what could be a better way of enjoying it?

Your Last Page



Seen at a local toy and hobby store in Sydney.

I can recall buying them at Coles and Wollworths for under \$10, but this could have been mine for \$35.

Sorry, but at that price I was not tempted.

Contacted AHOC Hot Wheels guru Alan Mitchell and he assures me that it's the going price these days.



Spot the problem with this 100 engine, apart from being yellow



How many SUs?
Are there two too many.
Thanks to Alwyn Keepence for this photo.



I have often thought that the chassis is bent in this Rally 3000 driven by Timo Makinen.

Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**
